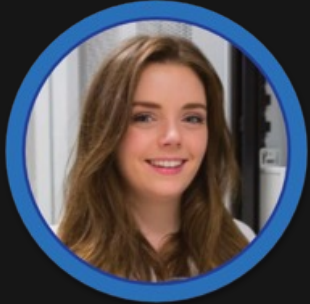




PERSONA: IT ARCHITECT

Products: [SPECIFIC PRODUCT(S) GO HERE]

Sales Play Name: [SALES PLAY(S) GO HERE]

Reports To: VP / Director of IT

Market Segment: Enterprise / SMB

Role: Decision Influencer

KEY CHARACTERISTICS

- Technical decision influencer, can also be decision makers (especially in S2 accounts)
- Designs IT architectures based on business strategy
- Typically owns the execution of the IT budget, roadmap, and influences IT strategy
- Manages IT resources in a hybrid environment
- Long-range technology futures, recommendations, new-tech evaluation

DRIVERS/GOALS

- **IT Agility:** implement new business processes and management methodologies.
- **Automation:** integrate existing systems with automation and optimization approaches for primary business processes.
- **IT Investments:** estimate required investments in technology and IT to promote modernization and digital transformation strategies. Calculate potential financial and efficiency returns from the strategic IT plan.
- **Designed for Innovation:** create an agile IT foundation that supports new products, adapts existing IT systems, and integrates complex data types to meet new market requirements.

PAIN POINTS/CHALLENGES

- Talent shortage / skills gap
- Rapid evolution of technology (obsolescence)
- Organizational silos and information fiefdoms
- Lack of IT agility to support business needs
- Advanced user expectations based on cloud-like and consume app experiences
- Integration of disparate systems and data silos
- Abundance of data, but lack of real insights
- Inefficient data security and cyber resilience strategies

HOW THIS PERSONA SUCCEEDS

- Advisor to IT leadership and the business units regarding alignment of IT capabilities to strategic and tactical activities
- Validate new technology requirements and associated architecture - including research, POCs, trials, etc.
- Act as the the liaison with external suppliers to understand how vendor-solutions can be incorporated.
- Execute the IT strategy, integrate existing systems where appropriate, optimize IT through automation and with new technology that saves on power, cooling and space.
- Collaborate with organizational departments to develop IT proposals and high-level data architecture designs.

HOW [PRODUCT/SOLUTION] HELPS

- Benefit 1
- Benefit 2
- Benefit 3
- Benefit 4

ENGAGEMENT RECOMMENDATIONS

- *Discover*
 - The EA is heavily involved in remaining well educated on what IT solutions are available in the market. They are relied on to research the available options, narrow the target vendor list, consider the degree of interoperability, make a product recommendation, and deliver a rough integration plan.
- *Consider*
 - The EA is actively engaged and values influencer input and consumes a broad mix of content (analyst reports, case studies, technical articles, webinars, reviews, blogs, competitive comparisons, evaluation data, etc.).
 - Watering Holes: Tradeshows, EBCs, analyst events, LinkedIn/Twitter, Web/Internet search, webinars, YouTube, G2Cloud (and similar), user groups.
- *Decide*
 - EA is the primary decision influencer; may be the decision maker in some cases, but exec owns budget
 - EA values **previous vendor experiences, transparent pricing, and interoperability** as primary drivers



IT ARCHITECTS



REASONS TO UTILIZE ON-PREM

1. High quality/reliable products – **33%**
2. Easy/timely mgmt/monitoring – **32%**
3. Compatibility w/ legacy systems – **31%**



REASONS TO UTILIZE HYBRID CLOUD

1. Reduced IT workload – **35%**
2. Ease of mgmt – **32%**
3. Most efficient – **30%**

HYBRID CLOUD PURCHASING JOURNEY

MOST APPEALING HYBRID CLOUD BENEFITS



1. Improved scalability & flexibility – **46%**
2. Increased business agility – **44%**
3. Security/protection – **40%**

KEY HYBRID CLOUD CONSIDERATIONS



1. Reliability; Performance – **53%**
2. Manageability – **39%**
3. Security controls – **38%**

TOP INFO RESOURCES



1. Data-backed industry trends – **44%**
2. Mfr/vendor websites – **36%**
3. Consultants/industry experts; Internet search – **30%**

HYBRID CLOUD CHALLENGES



1. Interoperability – **38%**
2. Identifying best solution – **37%**
3. Finding cost/pricing – **33%**

MOST VALUABLE INFO



1. Tech specs; Performance data – **39%**
2. Compliance standards/requirements – **29%**
3. Technical/Architectural solution details; Pricing/value – **26%**

DESIRED ASSET TYPES



1. Whitepapers – **32%**
2. Tech spec sheets – **28%**
3. Product reviews – **27%**

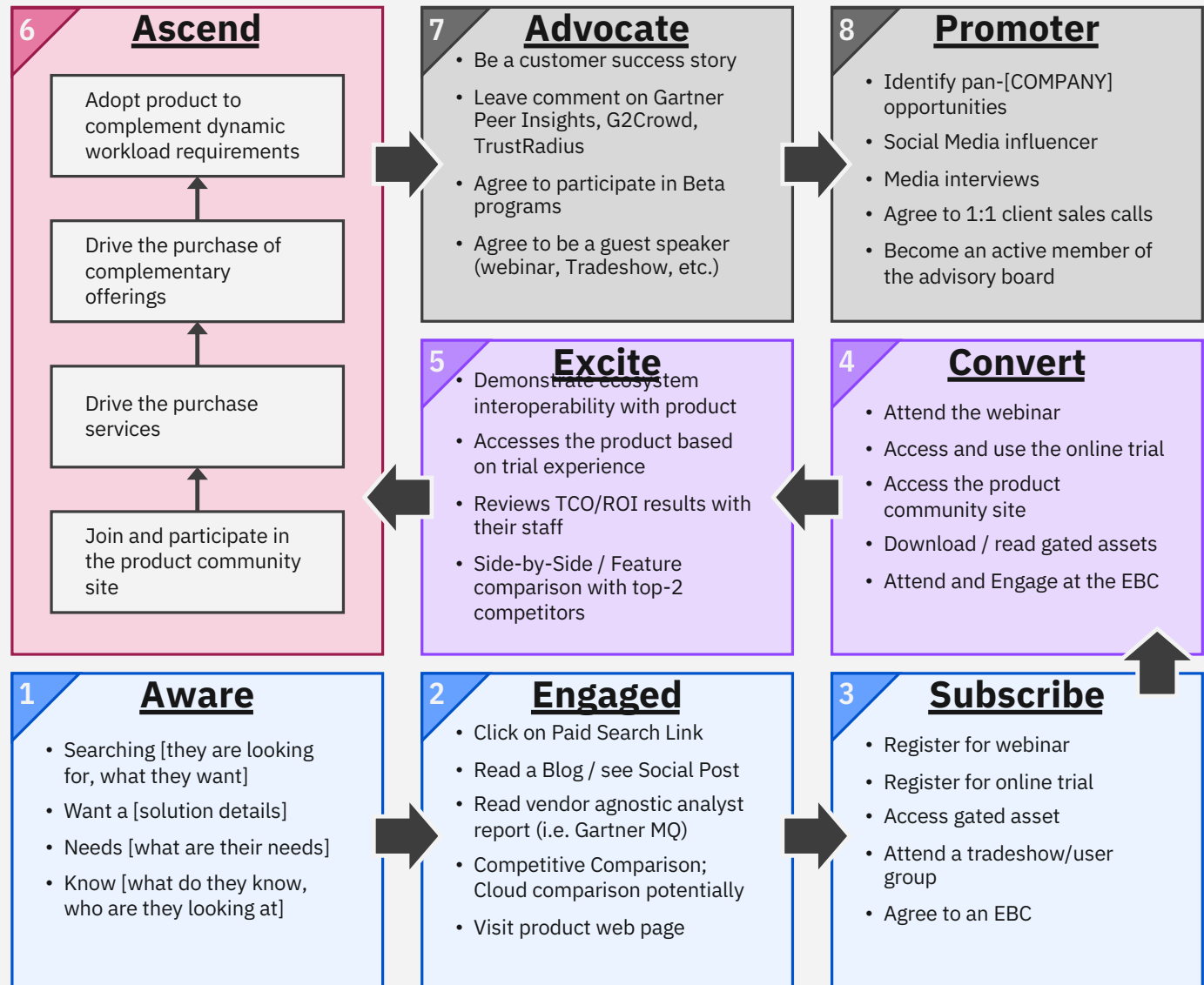
Marketing Journey

IT Architect

Focus: *Cyber Resiliency*

Concentration: *IT Infrastructure (on/off prem)*

Circumstances: *Their awareness level of the product(s) and how their journey starts.*



IT Architect Buyer's Engagement Journey Map

